

Daisy Attaway

+1-903-315-7709 | daisy.attaway@austin.utexas.edu | dattaway.github.io | [in](#) | [g+](#) | [id](#) | Austin, TX

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin, Austin, TX

Aug 2023 - May 2027

Bachelor of Science, Physics and Astronomy

• GPA: 3.95/4.00

- Relevant Coursework: Mechanics, Electricity and Magnetism, Wave Motion and Optics, Modern Physics and Thermodynamics, Classical Dynamics, Quantum Mechanics I and II, Electrodynamics I and II, Astrophysics, Cosmology, Galaxies and the Universe.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Galaxy Evolution Vertically-Integrated Program (GEVIP), Austin, TX

Advisor: Prof. Steven Finkelstein

Project: **Narrow-line AGN Selection in Quiescent Galaxies**

Dec 2025 - Present

- Designed and proposed a capstone project identifying narrow-line active galactic nuclei (AGN) in quiescent galaxies to study AGN feedback in the early universe.
- Identifying quiescent galaxies in the RUBIES survey using rest-frame photometric color selection and specific star formation rates from spectrophotometric SED fitting.
- Select narrow-line AGN using emission line diagnostic diagrams, search for evidence of outflows, and study quenching timescales of the host galaxies.

Project: **Checking Observed NIRSpect Redshift Fits**

Jan 2025 - May 2025

- Collaborated with seven undergraduate researchers to visually inspect 1000+ spectra to identify key spectral features and manually verify the redshift.
- Compared validated redshifts to computed redshifts of 5 automated spectral energy distribution (SED) fitting codes.

Exoplanet Atmospheres, Austin, TX

Advisor: Prof. Caroline Morley

Project: **Improving Mie Calculations with Machine Learning**

May 2025 - Present

- Developed artificial neural networks (ANNs) using TensorFlow to optimize opacity calculations of exoplanet clouds with complex compositions.
- Designing a Python package, [MieNet](#), to make machine learning model publicly available and contribute to the Virga cloud model.

PUBLICATIONS

Attaway, D., Kiefer, S., et al, 2026, in prep., "MieNet: A Python Package for Fast Well-mixed Cloud Particle Opacity Calculations".

Kiefer, S., **Attaway, D.**, et al, 2026, in prep., "Heterogeneous Cloud Particles in the Virga Cloud Code: Model Description and Application to YSES-1 c".

HONORS AND AWARDS

Melvin J. Rieger Scholarship Fund in Physics, UT Austin

Aug 2024, Aug 2026

Honors - College Scholar, UT Austin

Apr 2025, Apr 2026

Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship (SURF), UT Austin

May 2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Astronomy Department, UT Austin, Austin, TX

Aug 2026 - Present

Undergraduate Course Assistant

- Grade assignments and projects for 100+ students in a timely and consistent manner.
- Release assignment answer keys and handle student concerns.

Physics Department, UT Austin, Austin, TX

Aug 2025 - Present

Engineering Physics Learning Assistant

- Coordinate with the professor and graduate teaching assistant to plan and facilitate a weekly problem-solving discussion for 100+ students.
- Host weekly office hours and assist with active learning techniques during lecture to improve student understanding of the course material.

Women in STEM (WiSTEM), UT Austin, Austin, TX **May 2025 - Aug 2025, May 2026 - Aug 2026**
Camp Counselor

- Facilitated hands-on design challenges and imparted STEM college and career resources during WiSTEM's summer STEM camp with over 200+ high-school campers.
- Moderated and assisted weekly WiSTEM Webinars to discuss career pathways with STEM professionals for 50+ high-school and college attendees.
- Created engaging and informative content for WiSTEM's Instagram, Facebook, and LinkedIn that increased profile activity by an average of 20%.

Office of the President, UT Austin, Austin, TX **Aug 2023 - May 2025**
External Relations Student Associate

- Maintained and documented over 6,000+ physical and digital ticket inventory for 50+ Texas Athletics football, basketball, and baseball games annually for the presidential inventory.
- Recorded 150+ performing arts events at Moody Center annually through Microsoft Excel spreadsheets.
- Created, reviewed, and edited digital memos, guest lists, and email communications for accuracy, consistency, and professionalism presented to university administration and external stakeholders.

CONFERENCE ATTENDANCE AND PRESENTATIONS

Women in STEM Summer Camp: STEM in Sky and Space, Austin, TX **July 2025**
 • Talk: *"Cloudy with a Chance of Machine Learning: Neural Network Predictions for Well-Mixed Exoplanet Cloud Particles"*

Technology & Science Undergraduate Research Forum, Austin, TX **Apr 2026**
 • Poster: **Attaway, D.**, Taylor, A., Ortiz, O., Gupta, A., Finkelstein, S.
"Narrow-line AGN Selection in Quiescent Galaxies: Exploring AGN Feedback in the Early Universe"

Physics and Astronomy Undergraduate Symposium, Austin, TX **Apr 2026**
 • Talk: *"Cloudy with a Chance of Machine Learning"*, **Symposium Winner**

Conference for Undergraduate Women and Gender Minorities in Physics, Denver, CO **Mar 2026**
 • Poster: **Attaway, D.**, Kiefer, S., Morley, C.
"Predicting Mie Coefficients for Well-mixed Cloud Particles Using Machine Learning"

Frank N. Bash Symposium: New Horizons in Astronomy, Austin, TX **Sept 2025**

Technology & Science Undergraduate Research Forum, Austin, TX **Apr 2025**
 • Poster: **Attaway, D.**, Ellis, Z., Gerard, M., Gupta, A., Kerrigan, A., Sampson, K., Song, H., Viera, A.
"CONFIRM: Cross-checking Observed NIRSpect Fits for Improved Redshift Measurements"

UT Physics Directed Reading Program Symposium, Austin, TX **Apr 2025**
 • Talk: *"CMB: Properties, Detection, and Research"*

Conference for Undergraduate Women and Gender Minorities in Physics, Boulder, CO **Jan 2025**

UT Physics Directed Reading Program Symposium, Austin, TX **Dec 2024**
 • Talk: *"The Modeling of Feedback in Star Formation simulations"*

Weinberg Institute for Theoretical Physics Conference, Austin, TX **Nov 2024**

LEADERSHIP AND OUTREACH

Galaxy Evolution Vertically-Integrated Program (GEVIP) **Aug 2026 - Present**
Senior Leader

- Serve as a contact point and resource for junior GEVIP members.
- Hold weekly office hours to answer questions related to research or career preparation.

Women in Stem (WiSTEM), UT Austin**Aug 2025 - May 2026***Outreach Ambassador*

- Facilitated activity stations at K-12 science events with 200+ participants to promote STEM careers.
- Served on an undergraduate STEM major panel to inform K-12 students about STEM majors.

Physics Mentorship Program**Aug 2025 - May 2026***Undergraduate Physics Mentor*

- Met monthly with a freshmen physics mentee to advise on class registration and getting involved with research and share information about the physics department.

Society of Physics Students (SPS)**Apr 2025 - May 2026***Public Relations Officer*

- Maintained SPS socials and website to inform members of upcoming events and opportunities using Instagram, Canva, and WordPress.
- Organized weekly meetings for 50+ physics students to explore opportunities within the university and receive career insight in industry, academia, and research.
- Collaborated with other student organizations to facilitate a career event for 100+ attendees with 15 industry and academic speakers.

Women in Stem (WiSTEM), UT Austin**Feb 2025, Feb 2026***Girl Day Volunteer*

- Led night sky tours using an inflatable observatory to 100+ K-12 students.
- Photographed volunteers, participants, and event stations for WiSTEM promotional content.

Galaxy Evolution Vertically-Integrated Program (GEVIP)**Jan 2025 - May 2025***Website Co-Leader*

- Implemented new ideas for the Galaxy Evolution VIP website using WordPress and other design platforms to maintain a professional and engaging webpage.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python, Git, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Jupyter
- **Other:** Microsoft Office Suite, Excel, Salesforce, Qualtrics

OBSERVING TIME

4 nights on Harlan J. Smith Telescope (2.7m), McDonald Observatory**June 2025**